MINISTRIES DEPARTMENTS AND CENTRAL SECRETARIAT

CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE → AOB AND TOB: JURISDICTION → INSTITUTION MAP: POLITICAL HEAD → MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE → CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND → SECRETARIAT HIERARCHY AND DELEGATED

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final cone synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE OPERATING CHAIN

CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE OPERATING CHAIN · ROOT QUESTION · HOW DOES PARLIAMENTARY EXECUTIVE AUTHORITY BECOME ORGANISED GOVERNMENTAL ACTION? · ARTICLES 73 + 74 ←→ UNION EXECUTIVE FIELD AND ←→ POLITICAL AUTHORITY REMAINS CONSTITUTION-BOUNDED · ARTICLE 77 ←→ ACTION IN PRESIDENT'S NAME AND AUTHENTICATION · ←→ ARTICLE 77(3) BUSINESS-ALLOCATION AND TRANSACTION RULES · ARTICLE 78 ←→ PM COMMUNICATION AND INFORMATION DUTIES TO

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• ROOT QUESTION • How does parliamentary executive authority become organised governmental action? • ARTICLES 73 + 74 ←→ Union executive field and ministerial advice	• ←→ political authority remains Constitution-bounded. • ARTICLE 77 ←→ action in President's name and authentication • ←→ Article 77(3) business-allocation and transaction rules	• ARTICLE 78 ←→ PM communication and information duties to President • Ministerial direction → Secretariat advice/process → agency delivery → accountability. • MUST REMEMBER: Separate Articles 73-78, Allocation of Business jurisdiction, Transaction of	• Business procedure and each body's own statutory source.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Business procedure and each body's own statutory source.

01

STAGE 01

AOB AND TOB: JURISDICTION BEFORE PROCEDURE

AOB AND TOB · JURISDICTION BEFORE PROCEDURE · ARTICLE 77(3) · ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES WHO · TRAP RAIL · ARTICLE 309 · SCHEDULE CAN CHANGE · STATUTE STILL CONTROLS.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ARTICLE 77(3) ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES who handles what how a proposal is decided ministry/department + subjects disposal + consultation + escalation lawful owner + lawful decision route .	TRAP RAIL AoB != ToB both != Article 309	schedule can change statute still controls. ANSWER STRIP	Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• ARTICLE 77(3) • ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES who handles what how a proposal is • decided ministry/department + subjects disposal + consultation + escalation lawful owner + lawful decision route	• TRAP RAIL • AoB != ToB • both != Article 309	• schedule can change • statute still controls. • ANSWER STRIP	• Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.

02

STAGE 02

INSTITUTION MAP: POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY

INSTITUTION MAP · POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY · SECRETARIAT POLITICAL BROAD ALLOCATED POLICY/LAW/BUDGET CHARGE UNIT SUBJECT UNIT · ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE TECHNICAL LEAD EXECUTION/SERVICE TERRITORIAL · SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS STATUTORY BODY · AUTONOMOUS BODY · TRAP ADMINISTRATIVE ASSOCIATION DOES NOT ERASE THE SOURCE INSTRUMENT

PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit

ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain → SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body → autonomous body

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory • ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain	• SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body • autonomous body	• TRAP administrative association does not erase the source instrument or statutory independence. • PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory	• ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain • SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP administrative association does not erase the source instrument or statutory independence.

03

STAGE 03

MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE AND SECRETARY

MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE AND SECRETARY · POLITICAL EXECUTIVE · CABINET MINISTER · PORTFOLIO LEADERSHIP, CABINET PARTICIPATION, PARLIAMENT. · MINISTER OF STATE · INDEPENDENT CHARGE OR ASSIGNED ASSISTANCE, AS FORMALLY ALLOCATED. · PERMANENT EXECUTIVE · ADMINISTRATIVE HEAD + PRINCIPAL OFFICIAL ADVISER + TRANSACTION COMPLIANCE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
POLITICAL EXECUTIVE Cabinet Minister → portfolio leadership, Cabinet participation, Parliament. Minister of State → independent charge or assigned assistance, as formally allocated. PERMANENT EXECUTIVE	Secretary → administrative head + principal official adviser + transaction compliance. PRODUCTIVE RELATION elected priority → candid options/legality → recorded decision → loyal implementation. FAILURE BRANCHES politicised advice bureaucratic veto	civil direction short tenure hidden responsibility. ANSWER STRIP	Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• POLITICAL EXECUTIVE • Cabinet Minister → portfolio leadership, Cabinet participation, Parliament. • Minister of State → independent charge or assigned assistance, as formally allocated. • PERMANENT EXECUTIVE	• Secretary → administrative head + principal official adviser + transaction compliance. • PRODUCTIVE RELATION elected priority → candid options/legality → recorded decision → loyal implementation. • FAILURE BRANCHES politicised advice • bureaucratic veto	• civil direction • short tenure • hidden responsibility. • ANSWER STRIP	• Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.

04

STAGE 04

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND FILE PROCESS

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND FILE PROCESS · CENTRAL SECRETARIAT POLICY · FILE RAIL RECEIPT · SECTION EXAMINATION · INTER-DEPARTMENT CONSULTATION · DELEGATED OR HIGHER APPROVAL · SECTION OFFICER · UNDER SECRETARY

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy → FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options → inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval → authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTI. → Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy • FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options	• inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval • authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTI.	• Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director • Joint Secretary → Additional/Special Secretary → Secretary.	• TRAP not every file reaches Minister/Secretary; delegation is an accountability design, not evasion. • CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP not every file reaches Minister/Secretary; delegation is an accountability design, not evasion.

05

STAGE 05

SECRETARIAT HIERARCHY AND DELEGATED FILE DISPOSAL

SECRETARIAT HIERARCHY AND DELEGATED FILE DISPOSAL · SPECIAL/ADDITIONAL SECRETARY · JOINT SECRETARY · DIRECTOR/DEPUTY SECRETARY · UNDER SECRETARY · FILE RECEIPT · COMPETENT APPROVAL · RULE LOWEST COMPETENT DELEGATED LEVEL; AUTHORITY AND REASONS REMAIN

SECRETARY → SPECIAL/ADDITIONAL SECRETARY → JOINT SECRETARY

DIRECTOR/DEPUTY SECRETARY → UNDER SECRETARY → SECTION. → FILE receipt → examination/noting → consultation → competent approval → issue/authentication → record/monitoring.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• SECRETARY → SPECIAL/ADDITIONAL SECRETARY → JOINT SECRETARY • DIRECTOR/DEPUTY SECRETARY → UNDER SECRETARY → SECTION.	• FILE receipt → examination/noting → consultation → competent approval • issue/authentication → record/monitoring.	• RULE lowest competent delegated level; authority and reasons remain traceable. • CLOSE DISTINCTION: Keep the Central Secretariat, Cabinet Secretariat, PMO, ministries, departments, attached offices and delivery bodies institutionally distinct.	• SECRETARY → SPECIAL/ADDITIONAL SECRETARY → JOINT SECRETARY • DIRECTOR/DEPUTY SECRETARY → UNDER SECRETARY → SECTION.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE lowest competent delegated level; authority and reasons remain traceable.

06

STAGE 06

CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION

CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION · CABINET SECRETARIAT · CABINET PAPERS/DECISIONS · AOB-ToB ADMINISTRATION · CRISIS AND CONSENSUS. · PMO DIRECT ASSISTANCE TO PRIME MINISTER · PRIORITY REVIEW/ · MATTERS REQUIRING PM ATTENTION.

Cabinet papers/decisions	AoB-ToB administration	CoS	crisis and consensus.
PMO direct assistance to Prime Minister Cabinet Secretariat != Cabinet	priority review PMO != super-ministry	matters requiring PM attention. Cabinet Secretary != minister.	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• CABINET SECRETARIAT • Cabinet papers/decisions • AoB-ToB administration • crisis and consensus.	• PMO direct assistance to Prime Minister • priority review • matters requiring PM attention. • UNRESOLVED DIFFERENCE department consultation → Committee of Secretaries → concerned ministers	• Cabinet Committee/Cabinet under the prescribed route. • Cabinet Secretariat != Cabinet • PMO != super-ministry • Cabinet Secretary != minister.	• ANSWER STRIP • Central coordination should enable departments without erasing ministerial answerability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Central coordination should enable departments without erasing ministerial answerability.

07

STAGE 07

AGENCIES, AUTONOMY AND WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT OUTCOMES

AGENCIES, AUTONOMY AND WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT OUTCOMES · DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER ATTACHED/SUBORDINATE OFFICE · TECHNICAL/FIELD EXECUTION AUTONOMOUS BODY · CHARTERED SPECIAL FUNCTION · COMMERCIAL/STRATEGIC OPERATION REGULATOR · STATUTE-BASED ARM'S-LENGTH GOVERNANCE · WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM CLIMATE/DATA/SKILLS/WATER · MANY DEPARTMENTS

DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance → WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure. → CORRECTIVE named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback. → outcome failure.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function • CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance	• WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure. • CORRECTIVE named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback.	• LIMIT mission unit or dashboard cannot displace statute, sanction, Cabinet route or audit. • DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function	• CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance • WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT mission unit or dashboard cannot displace statute, sanction, Cabinet route or audit.

08

STAGE 08

CABINET COMMITTEES AND INTER-MINISTERIAL RESOLUTION

CABINET COMMITTEES AND INTER-MINISTERIAL RESOLUTION · CABINET COMMITTEE POLITICAL COLLECTIVE DECISION. · COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES ADMINISTRATIVE COORDINATION AND COMMON ADVICE. · CABINET SECRETARIAT PROCEDURE, AGENDA, RECORDS, MONITORING AND CONSENSUS. · PMO SUPPORT TO PM; NOT CABINET-RECORD CUSTODIAN OR SUPER-MINISTRY · ESCALATE UNRESOLVED CROSS-GOVERNMENT CONFLICT, NOT EVERY ROUTINE FILE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
CABINET / CABINET COMMITTEE political collective decision. COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES administrative coordination and common advice.	CABINET SECRETARIAT procedure, agenda, records, monitoring and consensus. PMO support to PM; not Cabinet-record custodian or super-ministry.	ESCALATE unresolved cross-government conflict, not every routine file. CABINET / CABINET COMMITTEE political collective decision.	COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES administrative coordination and common advice. CABINET SECRETARIAT procedure, agenda, records, monitoring and consensus.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• CABINET / CABINET COMMITTEE political collective decision. • COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES administrative coordination and common advice.	• CABINET SECRETARIAT procedure, agenda, records, monitoring and consensus. • PMO support to PM; not Cabinet-record custodian or super-ministry.	• ESCALATE unresolved cross-government conflict, not every routine file. • CABINET / CABINET COMMITTEE political collective decision.	• COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES administrative coordination and common advice. • CABINET SECRETARIAT procedure, agenda, records, monitoring and consensus.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ESCALATE unresolved cross-government conflict, not every routine file.

09

STAGE 09

OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE

OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE · ACCOUNTABILITY GRID · POLITICAL AND POLICY SCRUTINY. · FINANCIAL LEGALITY, PROPRIETY AND PERFORMANCE. · TRANSPARENCY, LEGALITY AND PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY. · 2ND ARC PRINCIPLES · COMPETENCY-TO-POST FIT · MISSION KARMAYOGI DIGITAL RECORD

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ACCOUNTABILITY GRID Parliament/questions/DRSCs → political and policy scrutiny. budget/demands/CAG/PAC → financial legality, propriety and performance. RTI/courts/vigilance → transparency, legality and personal responsibility.	2nd ARC principles competency-to-post fit Mission Karmayogi digital record impact evaluation	stable tenure specialist/lateral support. Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition. TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.	CURRENT SNAPSHOT: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026 The 27 April 2026 Cabinet Secretariat directory identifies T. V. Somanathan as Cabinet Secretary. Ministry/department counts and portfolio labels remain notification-sensitive and are not frozen.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• ACCOUNTABILITY GRID • Parliament/questions/DRSCs → political and policy scrutiny. • budget/demands/CAG/PAC → financial legality, propriety and performance. • RTI/courts/vigilance → transparency, legality and personal responsibility.	• 2nd ARC principles • competency-to-post fit • Mission Karmayogi digital record • impact evaluation	• stable tenure • specialist/lateral support. • Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition. • TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.	• CURRENT SNAPSHOT: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026 • The 27 April 2026 Cabinet Secretariat directory identifies T. V. • Somanathan as Cabinet Secretary. Ministry/department counts and portfolio labels remain notification-sensitive and are not frozen.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.

10

STAGE 10

VERIFIED PYQS AND ANSWER EXECUTION

VERIFIED PYQS AND ANSWER EXECUTION · 2025 PRELIMS Q57 · ORGANISATION-MINISTRY PAIRS · 2020 GS-II Q7 · INSTITUTIONAL QUALITY · CIVIL-SERVICE + DEPARTMENTAL REFORM. · 2020 GS-II Q8 · DIGITAL REVOLUTION · 2025 PRELIMS Q57: organisation-ministry pairs → NONE.

2020 GS-II Q7: institutional quality → civil-service + departmental reform. → 2020 GS-II Q8: digital revolution → lawful integrated e-governance. → 2024 GS-II Q3: cabinet growth → practical parliamentary marginalisation.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• 2025 PRELIMS Q57: organisation-ministry pairs → NONE. • 2020 GS-II Q7: institutional quality → civil-service + departmental reform.	• 2020 GS-II Q8: digital revolution → lawful integrated e-governance. • 2024 GS-II Q3: cabinet growth → practical parliamentary marginalisation.	• ANSWER constitutional source → organisation → mechanism → accountability → reform. • 2025 PRELIMS Q57: organisation-ministry pairs → NONE.	• 2020 GS-II Q7: institutional quality → civil-service + departmental reform. • 2020 GS-II Q8: digital revolution → lawful integrated e-governance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER constitutional source → organisation → mechanism → accountability → reform.

11

STAGE 11

UPSC SYNTHESIS: ORGANISED AUTHORITY WITH TRACEABLE RESPONSIBILITY

UPSC SYNTHESIS · ORGANISED AUTHORITY WITH TRACEABLE RESPONSIBILITY · PRELIMS FIREWALL · PRESIDENT'S NAME · PERSONAL DECISION · CABINET SECRETARIAT · CABINET COMMITTEE · COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES ATTACHED OFFICE

PRELIMS FIREWALL → President's name != personal decision → Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat → Cabinet Committee != Committee of Secretaries attached office != autonomous body → regulator autonomy survives ordinary instruction.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• PRELIMS FIREWALL • President's name != personal decision • Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat • Cabinet Committee != Committee of Secretaries attached office != autonomous body	• regulator autonomy survives ordinary instruction. • MAINS SPINE • Articles 73/74/77/78 → AoB-ToB → ministry/department • Minister-Secretary → Secretariat/file → coordination	• agencies/outcomes → oversight → reform. • PYQ SPINE • 2025 organisation-ministry pairs → verify allocated subject and parent law. • VERDICT effective machinery aligns functions, funds, functionaries, expertise and answerability.	• LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: The 27 April 2026 Cabinet Secretariat directory identifies T. V. • Somanathan as Cabinet Secretary; ministry and department counts are not frozen.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT effective machinery aligns functions, funds, functionaries, expertise and answerability.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · MACHINERY-OF-GOVERNMENT DESIGN · PRINCIPAL-AGENT CHAIN · CENTRE-OF-GOVERNMENT TENSION · AUTONOMY-ACCOUNTABILITY DILEMMA · POLICY CAPABILITY · REFORM EVALUATION · THIS COMPANION ADDS ORGANISATIONAL ANALYSIS ONLY.

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- Machinery-of-government design
- Principal-agent chain
- Centre-of-government tension
- Autonomy-accountability dilemma

ADVANCED LIMIT

- Policy capability
- Reform evaluation
- This companion adds organisational analysis only.
- Machinery-of-government design Departmentalization may follow purpose, process, clientele, territory or sector.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Specialisation improves expertise but increases coordination cost; consolidation can clarify ownership but overload the apex.
- Principal-agent chain Citizens delegate through Parliament, ministers, secretaries, departments and agencies.
- Information asymmetry, multiple principals and blame shifting require transparent mandates, audit, reasons, grievance and performance evidence.
- Centre-of-government tension Cabinet Secretariat and PMO can resolve cross-government failure.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels